Associate Design Researcher, Quicksand

Job Purpose and Description

Design research is one of the foundations of our practice, finding applications in almost all aspects of consulting and independent work of the studio. While we are open to considering applications from a variety of design disciplines pertinent to our work (service design, industrial design, interaction design amongst those most relevant to this profile), we are looking for individuals who are able to demonstrate a clear understanding of systems design and an ability to express project outputs through a combination of conceptual sketches, storyboards, lo-fi prototypes and other forms of visualisation.

Some specific responsibilities of this role are:

Planning and leading design research studies

- in response to project briefs, develop an iterative design, research and testing plan leading to the desired project outcomes
- design discussion guides, research probes, tools and participatory exercises with research subjects
- lead and facilitate in-field conversations and discussions
- facilitate co-creation sessions with a variety of stakeholders
- manage research logistics (travel schedules, participant recruitments, research rewards, consent etc)
- document in-field findings through note-taking, rapid sketches and the use of rich media like film and photography
- supplement primary research with secondary research and analysis

Synthesis and concept development

- use a variety of tools such as personas, journey maps, system maps, affinity clusters etc to synthesise research findings and distill user insights
- develop user-centered design solutions for the given problem statement
- apply rapid visualisation, prototyping and concept development skills to express emerging solutions in the form of storyboards, scenarios, design fiction, sketches, data visualizations etc.
- work with team members, external partners and vendors to collaboratively

develop design solutions and express solution concepts

Presentations and report writing

- create infographics, presentations, and written reports as part of interim and final project outputs

Qualifications

Successful candidates will be passionate about exploring aspects of the world through a critical and constructive eye. You'd be an extremely talented design researcher, with good observation, interaction skills and a co-creation attitude.

Some specific qualifications you would need to have are:

- A Bachelor's or Master's degree in design from a leading program in India or abroad with a specific focus on research (Industrial Design, Service Design, Design Management, Strategic Design, Design Methods etc) or the Social Sciences with adequate skills in conducting both qualitative and quantitative research
- 1-3 years of professional practice in your chosen field/s
- High level of skills in some foundational design softwares such as those in the Adobe Creative Suite
- Skills in design and development of research-based media - reports, summaries, books, online content, infographics, funding proposals, design development research, rich media based content and so on
- Excellent written and oral communication skills in English. Knowledge of any other languages (including Hindi) would be a definite plus but not mandatory
- Ability to think critically and have exceptional attention to detail
- A nuanced understanding of applied research and driving actionable research outcomes
- Evidence of experimentation with research ideologies, tools and approaches.
- Some evidence of independent creative work would be viewed very positively
- A roll-up-your-sleeves attitude towards your work

Location

The position will be based in Delhi, India. It will also involve a chance to meet and work with consumers across the spectrum for projects, as well as travel to workshops, client

meetings and the occasional company offsite!

Compensation

A compensation package commensurate with your skills and experience will be designed for you.

If all this sounds up your alley, please put together a document that highlights the following:

- Tell us about yourself and why you see yourself as a fit for this role?
- What specifically draws you to apply at Quicksand?
- Upload your resume/ portfolio / any other links that give us a window into who you are and what your interests are?